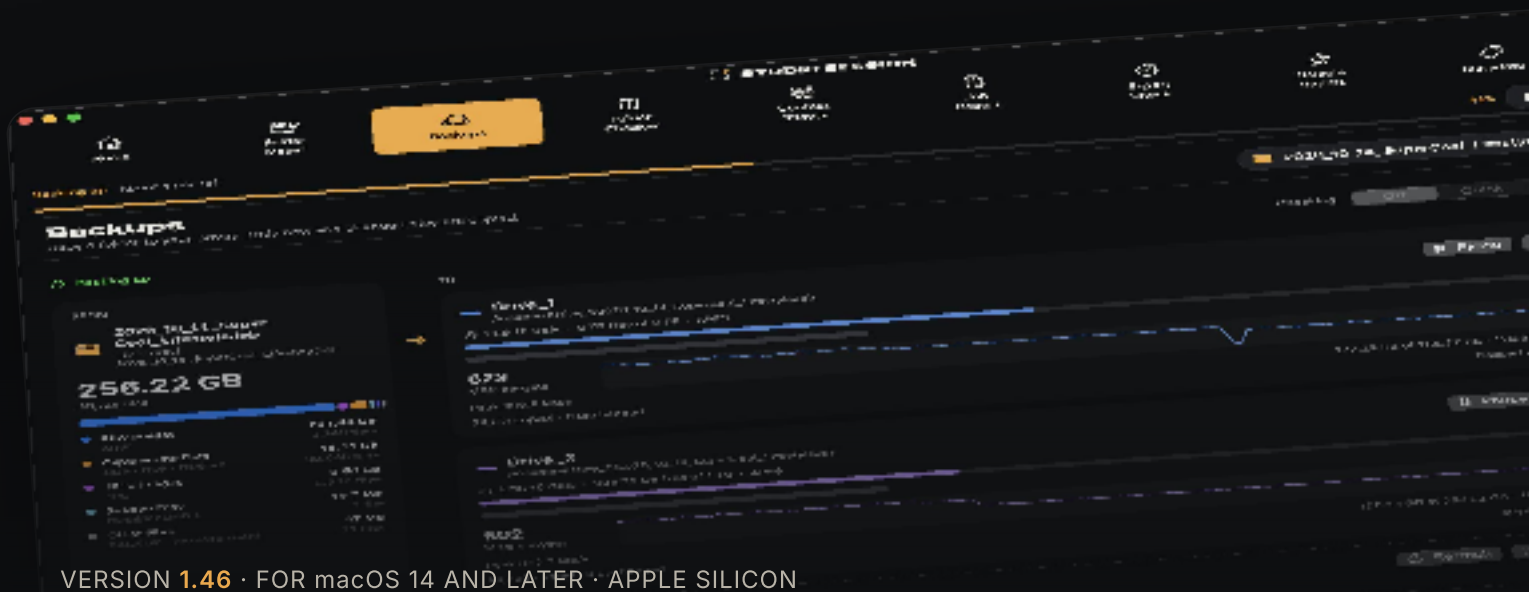
STUDIO SESSION

User Guide

Everything you need for a shoot day, one tool at a time.

USER GUIDE



VERSION 1.46 · FOR macOS 14 AND LATER · APPLE SILICON

CONTENTS

Inside this guide

Studio Session is a Mac app for digital techs and photographers: it opens your Capture One session, backs it up to as many drives as you like, checks the copies, and helps you deliver.

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03 Folder Maker

04 Set up a backup

05 Preview what will copy

06 While it copies

07 Folder Checker

08 Contact Sheets

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10 Export Check

11 Selects Report

12 Metadata

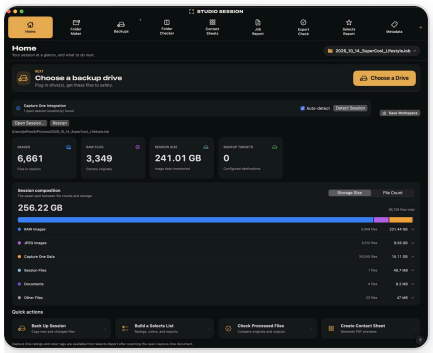
13 A shoot day, start to finish

14 Troubleshooting

01 OVERVIEW

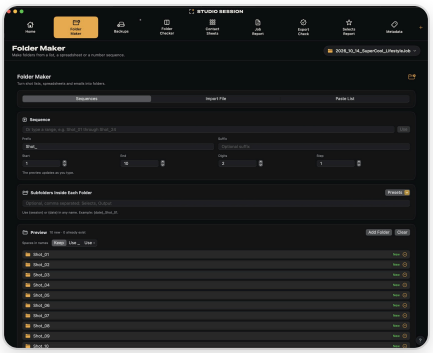
Getting around

Nine tools sit in tabs across the top. The session in use shows top right on every tab.



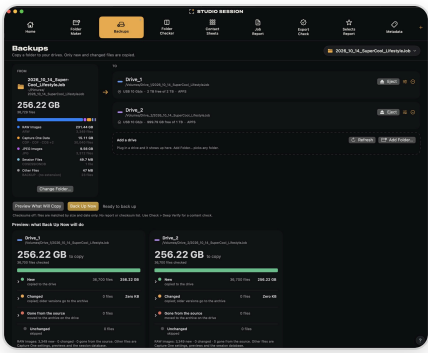
Home

Your session at a glance and the one thing to do next.



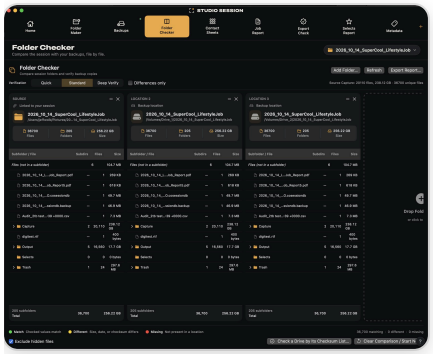
Folder Maker

Turn shot lists, spreadsheets and pictures of lists into folders.



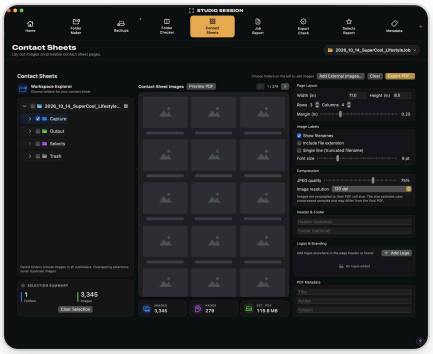
Backups

Copy the session to one or more drives. Only new and changed files are copied.



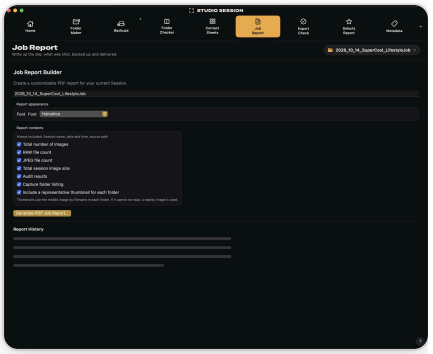
Folder Checker

Compare the session with its backups, file by file.



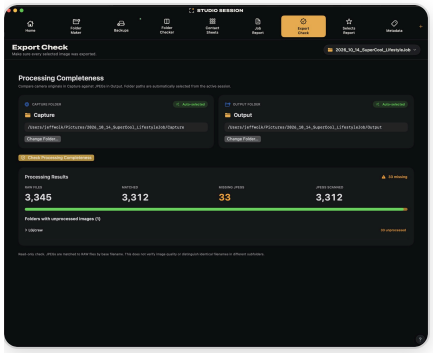
Contact Sheets

Lay images out on printable PDF pages.



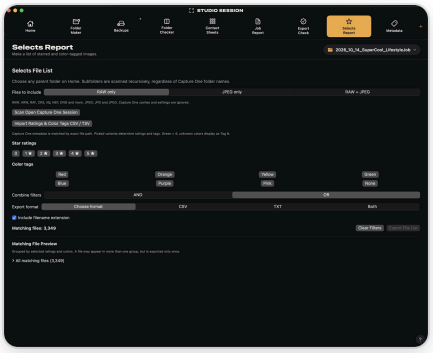
Job Report

A PDF write-up of what was shot, backed up and delivered.



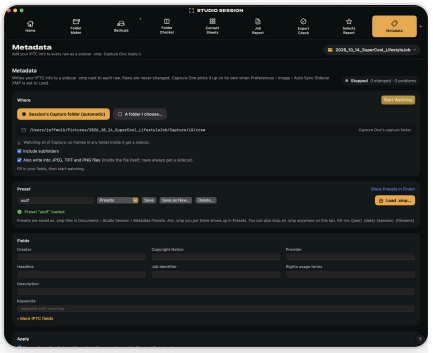
Export Check

Make sure every raw has an exported JPEG.



Selects Report

A file list of starred and color-tagged frames from Capture One.



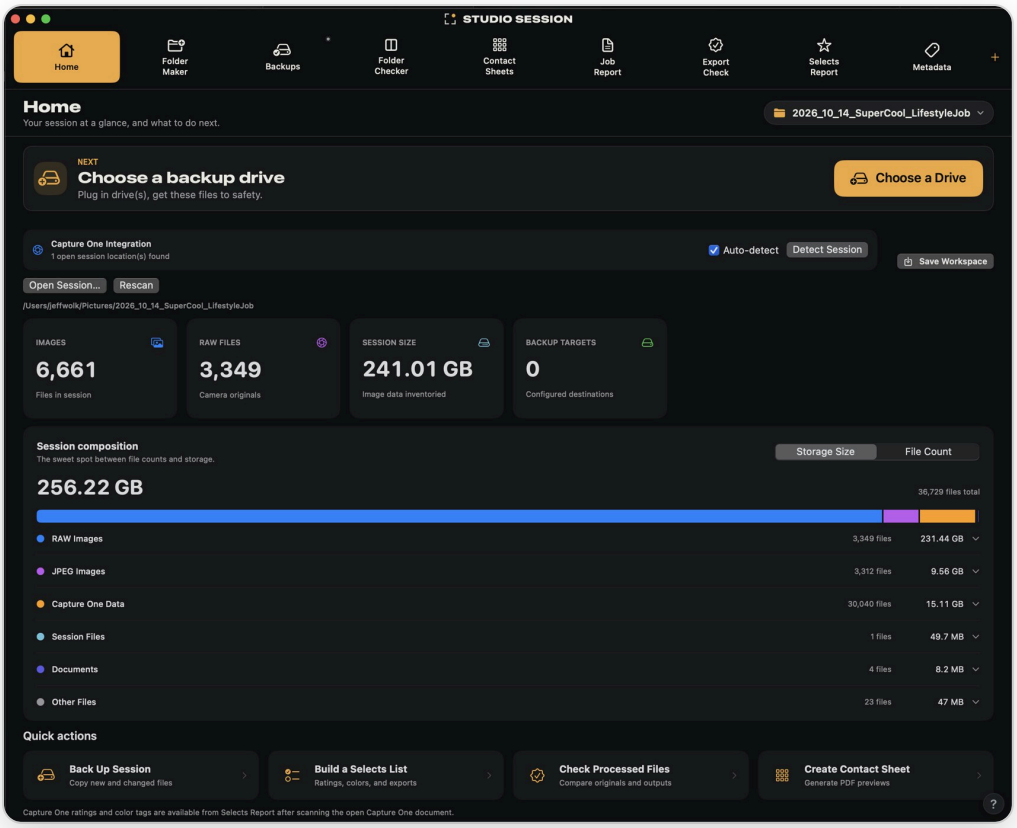
Metadata

Your IPTC info, written as a sidecar next to every raw as it lands.

02 HOME

Home

Your session at a glance, and what to do next.



Home with a session open

1. Open Capture One with your session, or click **Choose Session Folder...** and pick the session folder.
2. If Capture One is open, a dialog lists the sessions it has open. Pick one and click **Use This Session**. Nothing starts on its own.
3. Follow the **NEXT** card at the top. It always shows the one thing to do next, for example **Choose a Drive**.

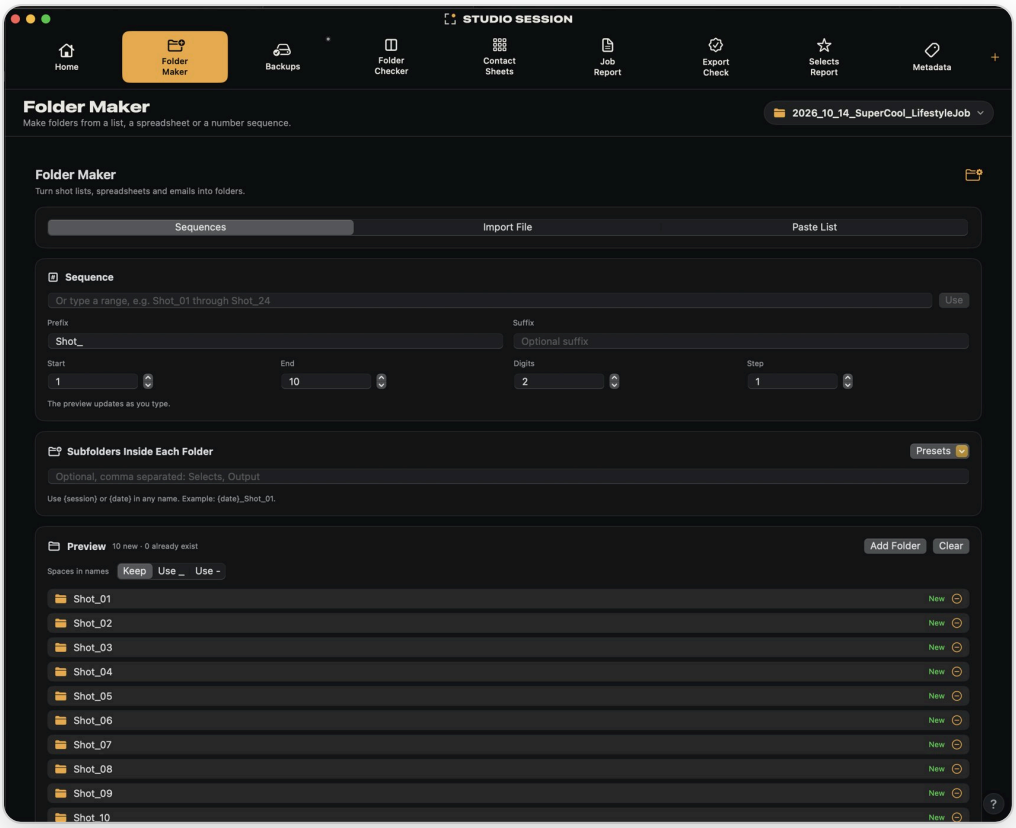
What you see

- **Images, Raw files, Session size, Backup targets:** a quick count of the session and how many drives it backs up to.
- **Session composition:** where the space goes (RAW, JPEG, Capture One data, documents and more). Switch between **Storage Size** and **File Count**.
- **Quick actions:** one click to Back Up Session, Build a Selects List, Check Processed Files or Create Contact Sheet.

03 FOLDER MAKER

Folder Maker

Make folders from a list, a spreadsheet or a number sequence.



Folder Maker with a ten-shot sequence ready to create

Three ways to make a list

METHOD	HOW IT WORKS
Sequences	Prefix, start, end, digits and step, for example Shot_01 to Shot_24. Or type a range in plain words and click **Use**. The preview updates as you type.
Import File	Choose an Excel (.xlsx), CSV or TSV file, then click a column. Each cell becomes a folder; blank cells are skipped. Pick the sheet and whether the first row is a header.
Paste List	One folder per line. Use / for subfolders, for example Look 1/Selects. Paste text, or click **Read a Picture...** for a photo or screenshot of a shot list. The text is read on your Mac.

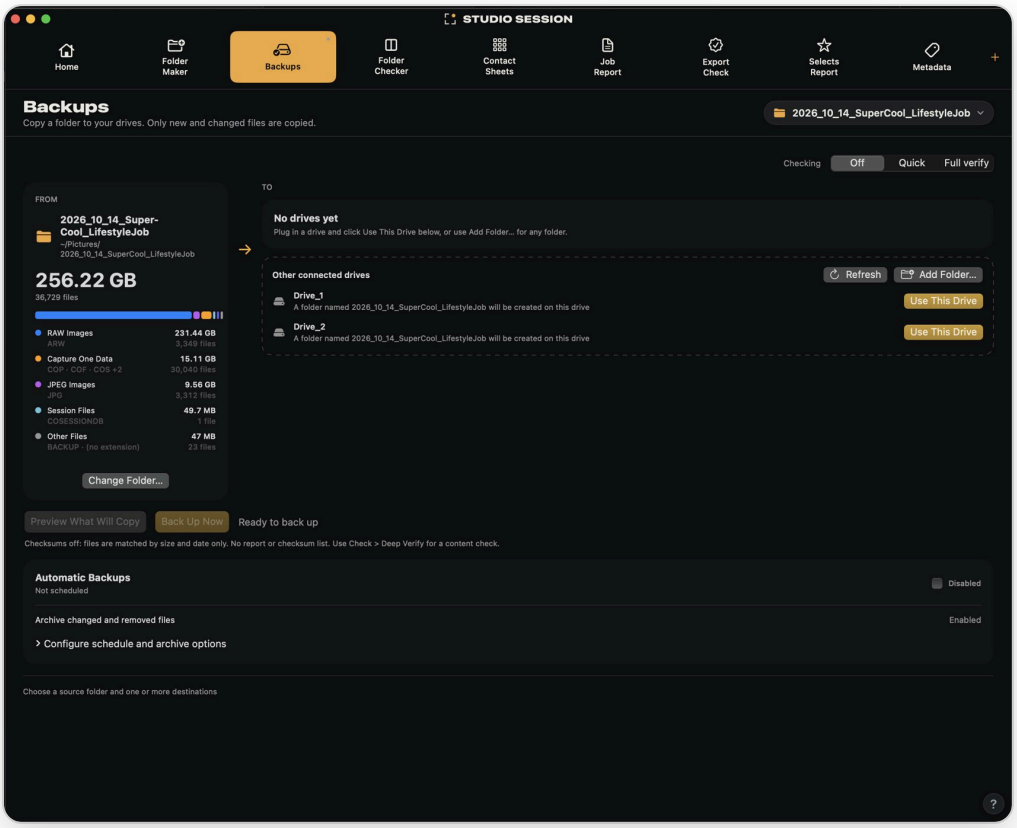
1. Build the list with one of the three methods.
2. Optional: under **Subfolders Inside Each Folder**, add folders to create inside each one (comma separated), or pick a saved preset.

3. Check the preview. Each row says **New** or that it already exists. Remove a row with its minus button.
4. Choose where to create them: Session, Capture, Output or a folder you choose.
5. Click **Create** and confirm.

04 BACKUPS

Set up a backup

Choose what to back up, where to, and how carefully to check it.



A source on the left; connected drives waiting on the right

1. Check the **FROM** card. It shows the folder being backed up, its size and what is in it. To back up a different folder, click **Change Folder...** or drop a folder on the card. Any folder works, not only Capture One sessions.
2. Plug in your drives. They appear under **Other connected drives**. Click **Use This Drive** and confirm **Create and Add**. If the drive already has a matching folder, it is used as is.
3. Pick **Checking** at the top: **Off**, **Quick** or **Full verify** (see the table below).
4. Optional: click **Preview What Will Copy** to see exactly what will be copied before anything is written.
5. Click **Back Up Now**.

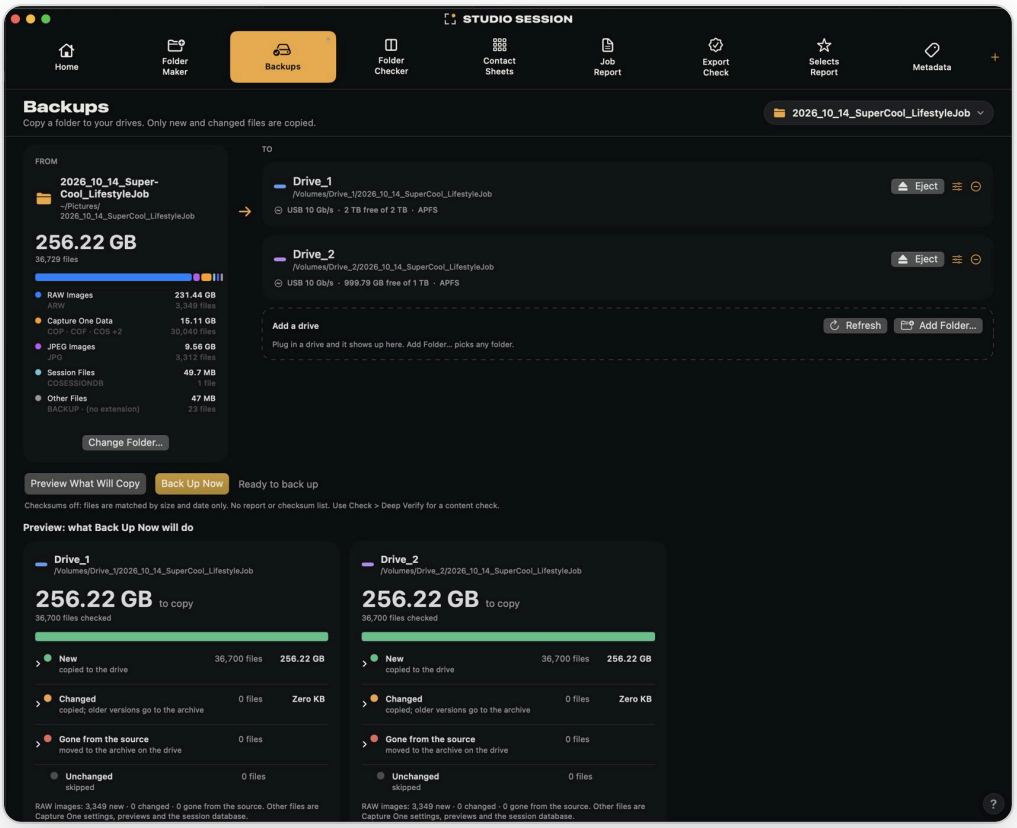
How carefully to check

CHECKING	WHAT IT DOES	WHEN TO USE IT
Off	Files are matched by size and date only. No report or checksum list.	Quick top-ups when speed is all that matters.
Quick	Each original gets an xxHash64 checksum while it copies, about as fast as Off. Copies are not read back.	The every-few-minutes backups during a shoot.
Full verify	Copies everything, then reads every copy back from the drive and compares it with the original. A copy that does not match is copied again.	The wrap-up backup at the end of the day. The safest.

05 BACKUPS

Preview what will copy

See what Back Up Now will do on each drive before it does it.



Preview: one card per drive, filled in as soon as each drive is checked

- The big number is how much will be copied to that drive.
- The bar and rows split the files into **New**, **Changed**, **Gone from the source** and **Unchanged**.
- Open a row to see the folders involved, with counts and sizes; open a folder to see every file. Capture One previews and settings sit in their own drawer inside each folder.

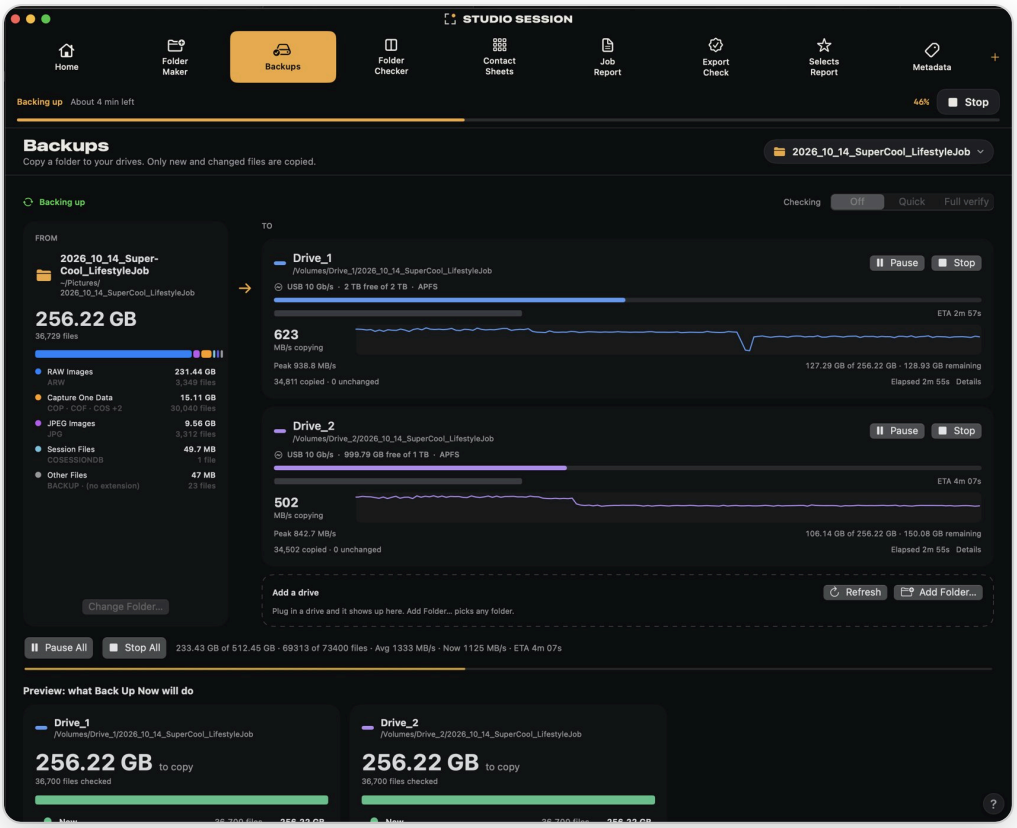
GOOD TO KNOW

A preview only reads. Nothing on the drives is changed.

06 BACKUPS

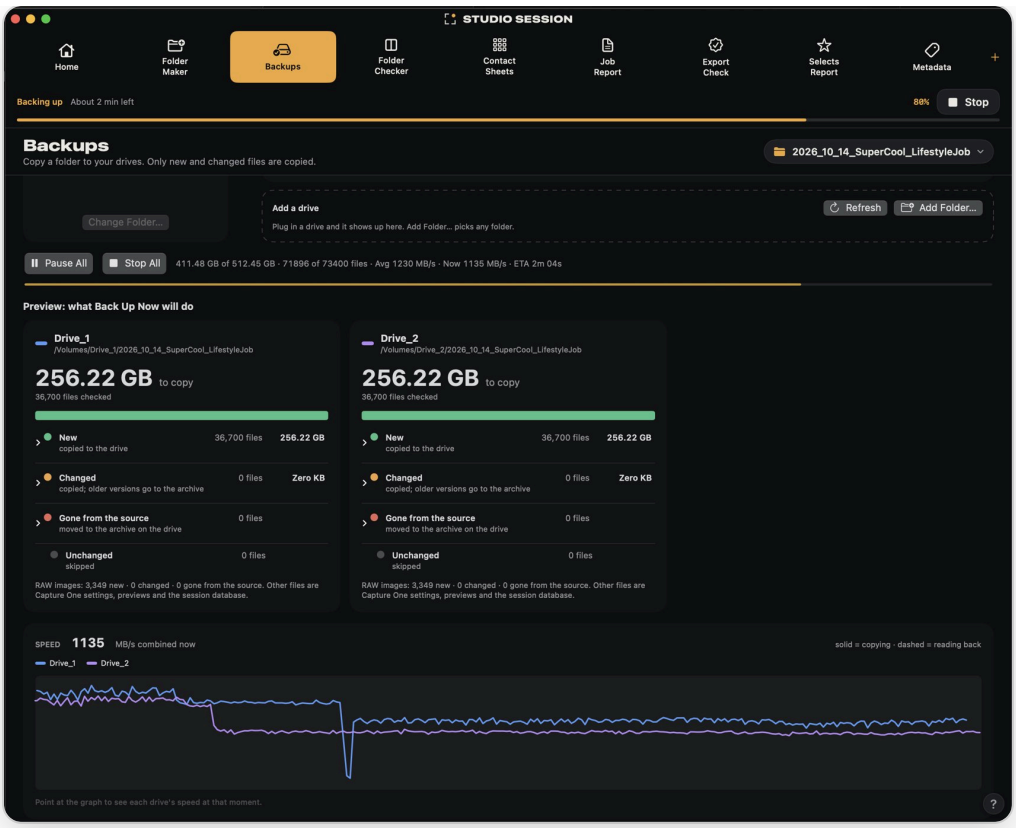
While it copies

Every drive's progress and speed, live.



Two drives copying at once, each in its own color

- Each drive has its own color, used for its bar and its speed lines.
- Each card shows its live speed, time left and its own **Pause** and **Stop**. Pausing or stopping one drive leaves the others running.
- **Pause All** and **Stop All** act on every drive. The strip under the tabs keeps the backup in view on any tab.
- Up to four drives copy at once; more wait their turn. A drive added mid-backup joins in.



The speed graph: one line per drive. Solid while copying, dashed while reading back.

Point at the graph to see each drive's speed at that exact moment.

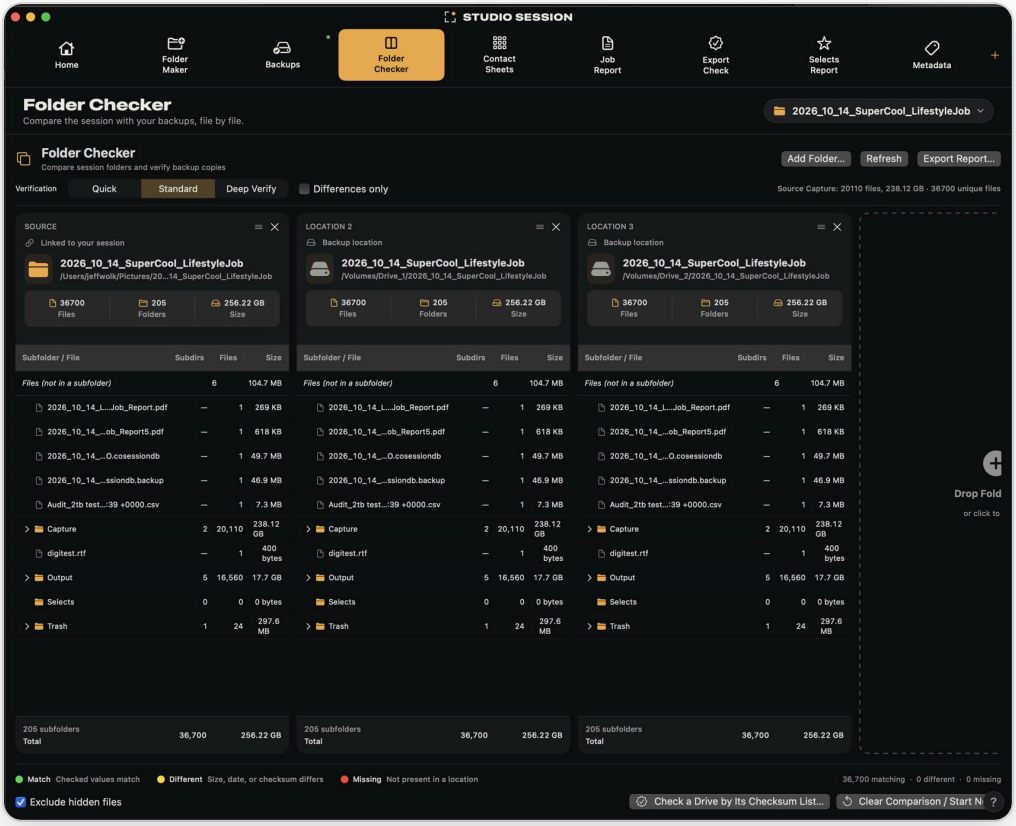
WHEN IT FINISHES

Each card reads **Up to date**. With Quick or Full verify, **Open Backup Report** opens the record on the drive. If a backup fails, a dialog you must click appears and the Dock icon bounces, so it can't be missed.

07 FOLDER CHECKER

Folder Checker

Compare the session with your backups, file by file.



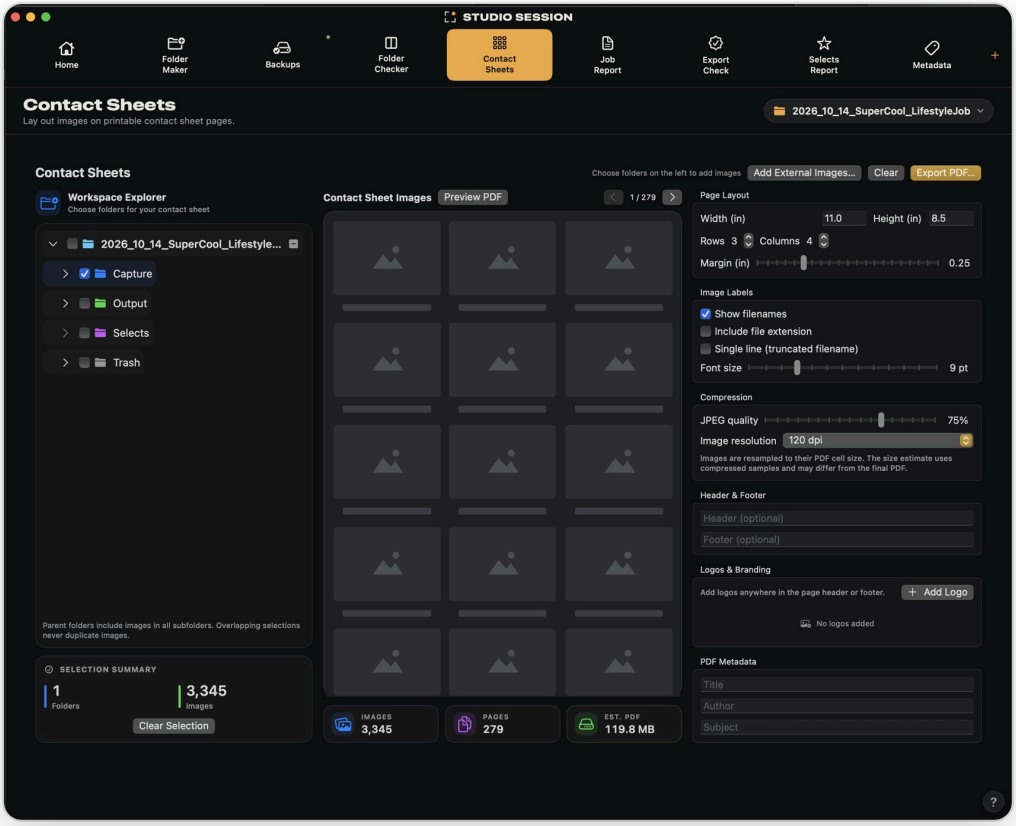
Three locations, every file matching

1. Open Folder Checker. Your session (source) and your backup folders are added for you. **Add Folder...** adds any other folder, or drop one on the empty column.
2. Pick a **Verification**: **Quick**, **Standard** or **Deep Verify**. Clicking one runs it.
3. Read the colors: green match, amber different, red missing. Turn on **Differences only** to hide everything that matches.

MODE	COMPARES
Quick	File names and sizes. Fastest.
Standard	Names, sizes and dates (2-second tolerance).
Deep Verify	Reads every file and compares SHA-256 hashes. Slowest; catches same-size content changes.

Contact Sheets

Lay out images on printable contact sheet pages.



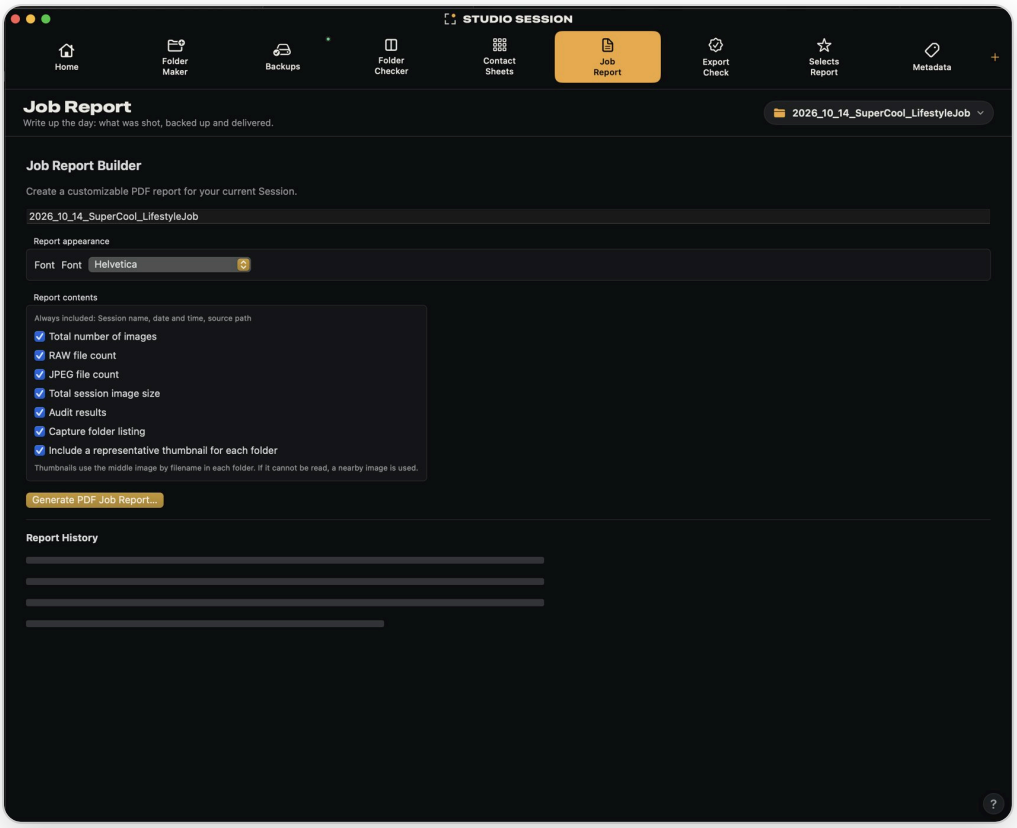
Contact Sheets (images hidden for this guide)

1. Tick folders in **Workspace Explorer**. A parent folder includes all its subfolders; an image is never added twice. **Add External Images...** adds images from anywhere.
2. Set the page: width and height in inches, rows, columns and margin.
3. Choose labels: filenames, extensions, one line, font size.
4. Click **Preview PDF** to page through it, then **Export PDF...**.

09 JOB REPORT

Job Report

Write up the day: what was shot, backed up and delivered.



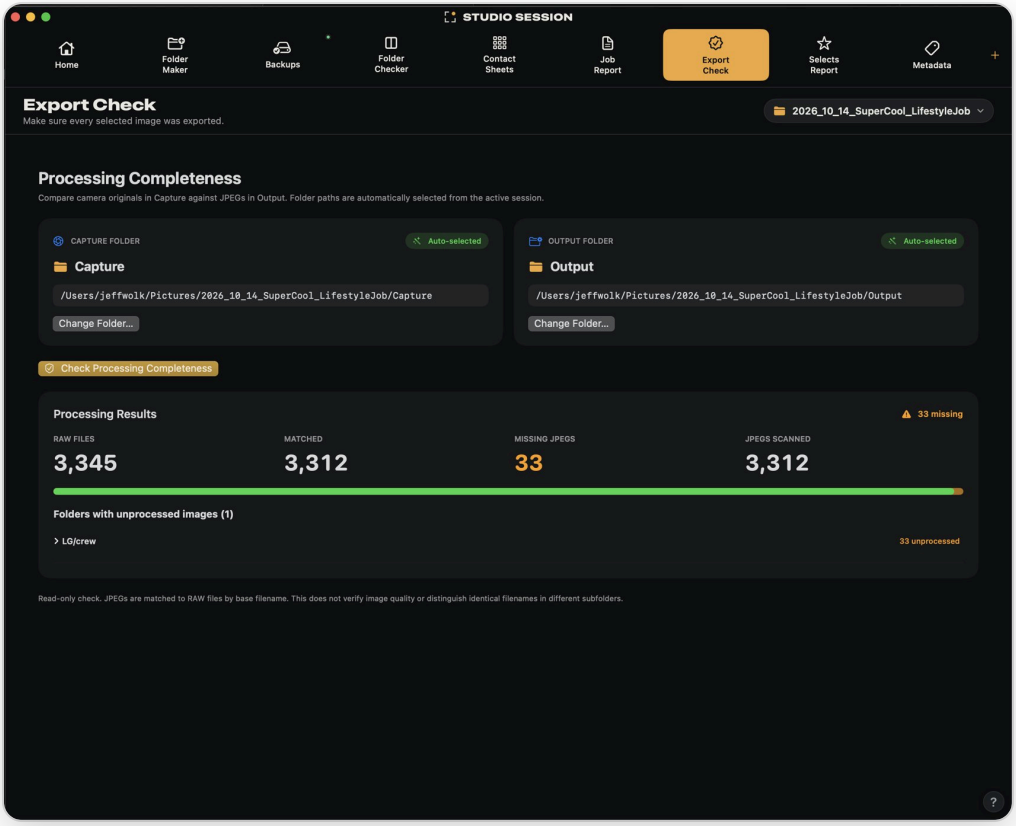
Job Report (report history hidden for this guide)

1. Check the report name (it starts as the session name) and pick a font.
2. Tick what to include: image totals, RAW and JPEG counts, session size, audit results and the Capture folder listing. Session name, date and source path are always included.
3. Optional: a thumbnail for each folder.
4. Click **Generate PDF Job Report...** and choose where to save it.

10 EXPORT CHECK

Export Check

Make sure every selected image was exported.



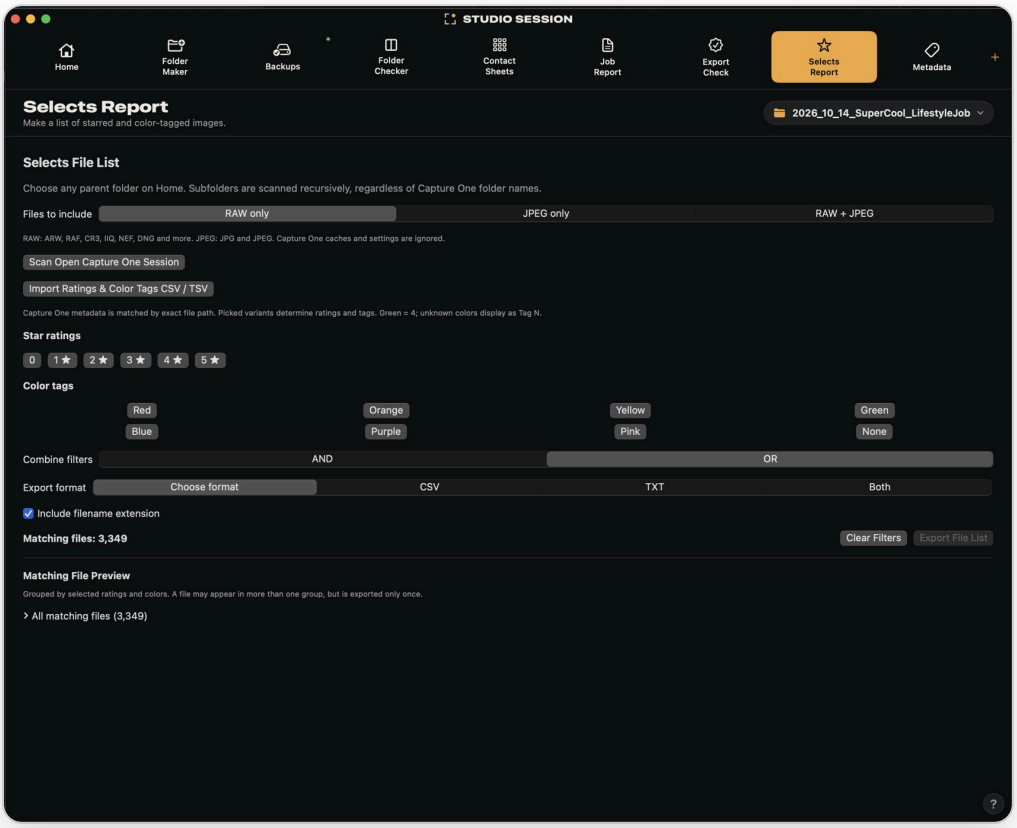
Export Check: 33 raws in one folder have no JPEG yet

1. The Capture and Output folders are picked from your session (**Auto-selected**). Use **Change Folder...** to pick others.
2. Click **Check Processing Completeness** .
3. Read the totals (RAW files, matched, missing JPEGs, JPEGs scanned) and open **Folders with unprocessed images** to see which frames still need exporting.

11 SELECTS REPORT

Selects Report

Make a list of starred and color-tagged images.



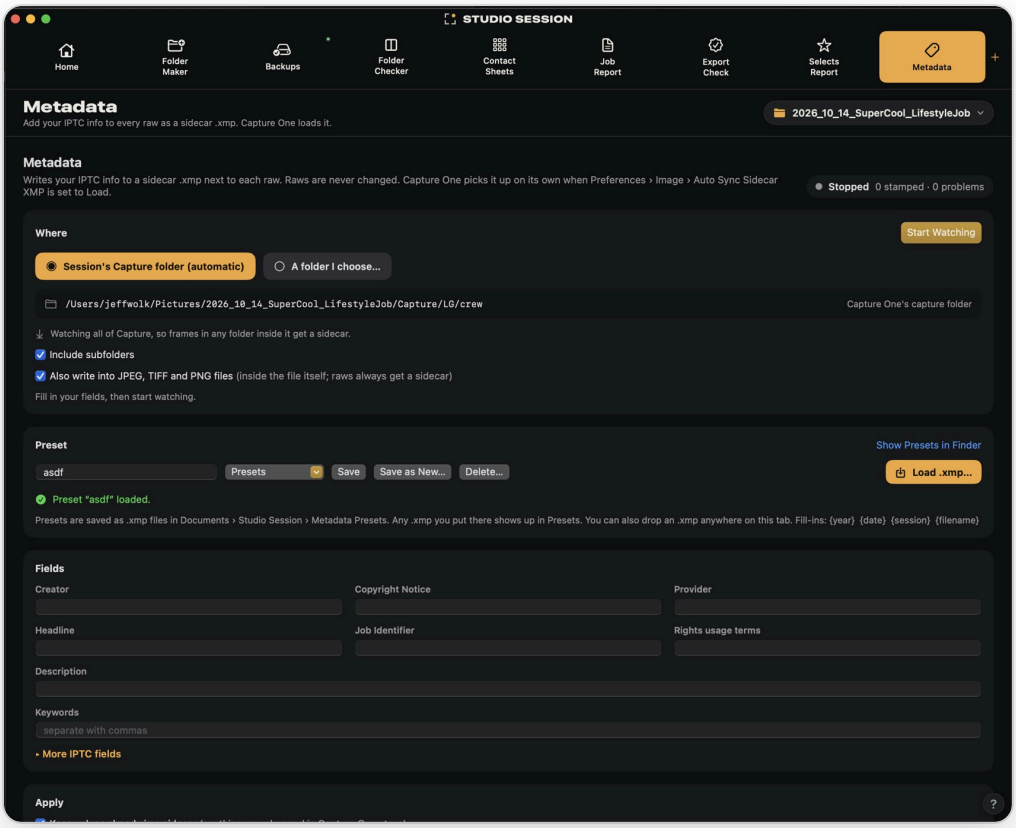
Selects Report

1. Choose **Files to include**: RAW only, JPEG only or RAW + JPEG.
2. With the session open in Capture One, click **Scan Open Capture One Session**. Or import ratings and color tags from a CSV or TSV file.
3. Pick star ratings and color tags. **AND** needs all of them; **OR** needs any.
4. Choose CSV, TXT or both, and whether to include the extension, then click **Export File List**.

12 METADATA

Metadata

Add your IPTC info to every raw as a sidecar .xmp. Capture One loads it.



Metadata

1. In Capture One, set Preferences › Image › Auto Sync Sidecar XMP to **Load** (once).
2. Fill in the fields (Creator, Copyright Notice, Provider, Headline, Job Identifier, Rights usage terms, Description, Keywords). **More IPTC fields** holds the rest, with Capture One's own names.
3. Under **Where**, keep **Session's Capture folder (automatic)**, or choose a folder.
4. Click **Start Watching**. Each new frame gets its sidecar within a second or two, and Capture One shows the fields.

RAWS ARE NEVER CHANGED

The info goes in a small .xmp file next to each raw, the same way Capture One and Lightroom do it.

13 WORKFLOW

A shoot day, start to finish

One way to use the tools together.

1. **Before the shoot:** open the session on Home, and build your shot folders in Folder Maker.
2. **Start of the shoot:** fill in Metadata and click Start Watching.
3. **During the shoot:** on Backups, add your drives, pick Quick, and turn on Automatic Backups.
4. **Wrap:** run a Back Up Now with Full verify, then confirm in Folder Checker.
5. **Deliver:** Export Check to catch missed exports, Selects Report for the client list, Contact Sheets and Job Report as PDFs.
6. **Leave:** Eject each drive before unplugging.

14 HELP

Troubleshooting

Common messages and what to do about them.

IF YOU SEE	DO THIS
Use This Drive did nothing	Make sure a folder is in the FROM card. Any refusal now explains itself in a dialog.
"Folder names don't match"	The drive's folder holds a backup of something else. Cancel and pick the right folder, unless you meant it.
A drive was held, "Nothing changed"	Many files left the source. Click Review... on the card. Cancel keeps the drive as it is.
Amber "still being written"	Normal while Capture One saves. The next backup catches those files.
Red "couldn't be backed up"	A file can't be read or is locked. The report names it and says how to fix it.
Backup is slower than usual	Check the drive is on a 10 Gb/s port and not nearly full. SSDs slow down after long writes; a rest helps.
Sidecars don't show in Capture One	Set Preferences › Image › Auto Sync Sidecar XMP to Load.

Download the latest version: github.com/WolkPhoto/studio-session-releases/releases/latest